

The Law-Related Education Academy is facilitated by the Arizona Foundation for Legal Services & Education with funding made possible by the Arizona Department of Education School Safety Program.

“Keeping School Cool: Reducing Aggressive Behaviors”: Academy
(Elementary 4-6)

Understanding Aggressive Behaviors Lesson Plan

Obtain Administrator Approval Prior to Implementing Lesson

Objectives: Students will...

- Team build with an icebreaker activity
- Learn about aggressive behaviors and their consequences
- Practice strategies to calm aggressive behaviors

Materials:

- ✓ Colored Cards: cut apart-1 card per student (slide 1; also see black and white option Slide 3)
- ✓ Color Card Key-posted or displayed (slide 2; also see black and white option slide 4)
- ✓ Large paper and markers for each group
- ✓ “Uncool” Matching Handout-1 per group (see below lesson pg. 4)

Team Teaching: For effective implementation of Law Related Education (LRE), team teach with the classroom teacher by...

- Having both the officer and teacher rotate to different groups. Both instructors will provide positive feedback and engage in friendly conversations with students. This procedure will help reduce classroom disruptions, increase student engagement and build supportive relationships with students.
- Encouraging classroom teachers to participate in all activities by injecting clarification statements and relating any relevant content to their curriculum. In this method, students will see more connections to their student life and be willing to carry over concepts and skills learned in LRE.
- Assigning the classroom teacher part of the lesson instructions. Team teaching with the classroom teacher enables the students to further see the importance of LRE lessons. It also provides opportunity for the classroom teacher to demonstrate teaching skills conducive for effective teaching. Student attention can be maintained easier with different voices and personalities experienced throughout the lesson.

Timeframe: 40 Minutes

Activity 1: Icebreaker and Group Sorter

1. Hand each student a different colored card. Instruct the students to move around the room and exchange their card with a peer then continue moving on to the next peer, exchanging cards again.
2. Allow students time to exchange their cards several times before you call time. Instruct the students to form groups of 4 with students that have a different colored card. The students should then sit together in their new group. Any students who did not find a group should be placed in a group or

create a new group.

3. Post the Color Card Key and explain that the statements help students examine behaviors at school that keep the environment calm. If students let emotions take over, it can cause behaviors that make the learning environment feel unsafe.
4. Instruct the students within each small group that have the red number 1 card, to read the statement displayed, aloud to their group, then finish the statement with their own answer. The other members of the group can also give their ending to the red card statement. Each group will repeat the process with yellow, green then blue statements.
5. Rotate to each group, listening to what is being shared, providing any necessary feedback.
6. Next, call out each colored statement and ask the group member from each group with that colored card to share one response from their group, aloud to the class. It could possibly be a response that most members of the group shared in common or is different than other groups reporting.

Statements: (any school appropriate answer is acceptable)

Red: I think school can be fun when... (Ex. Everyone gets along, there is no homework, we have assemblies, etc.)

Yellow: I think school can be uncool when... (Ex. There is too much work, students fight, it's hot, etc.)

Green: I think students stay calm when they... (Ex. Think before they respond, treat each other nicely, accept each other, etc.)

Blue: I think students lose their cool when they... (Ex. Let others push their buttons, get frustrated, feel left out, etc.)

Activity 2: Small Group Work

1. Provide the groups with a large poster paper and markers.
2. Supply each group with one copy of the "Uncool" Matching Handout and instruct the groups to review the handout and draw a line to match the term with the description. (optional: assign the group member with the yellow card)
3. Circulate among the groups, checking for accuracy. Call out each term and ask a different volunteer from each group to provide the description. (optional: assign the group member with the green card first then rotate to the next color for the next definition)

Anger –This emotion can make you feel hot or look red in the face. You may breathe faster or feel a stomach ache. This emotion can make you feel like clenching your fists or yelling. You may react to this emotion in a positive way by standing up for yourself. If you don't control this emotion and take it out on others, you can make things worse.

Aggression – This behavior can have violent actions and is meant to harm others and make them feel unsafe. Others may not want to be around that person. School has rules against acting out with this emotion. There are laws that protect people from being harmed by others expressing this emotion.

Physical Aggression – This behavior causes harm or threatens to cause harm to someone's person or things. It is against school rules and is also against the law. Hitting, kicking, biting and breaking things are some examples of this behavior. If you see someone with this behavior, you should stay away and get help.

Verbal Aggression – This behavior uses mean words or gestures to make others upset or feel bad about themselves. It hurts your relationship with others. Some forms include name-calling, insults, put-downs, threats and making fun of someone with jokes or mean comments. If someone uses this form of communication with you, respond with positive words and let them know you do not like it. If it continues walk away and tell an adult.

4. Next, demonstrate how to divide the poster paper into 4 quadrants and label each quadrant with the following headings. *(optional: assign the group member with the blue card)*

Q1 Aggression looks like... *(Ex. things being thrown, pushing or shoving, screaming, etc.)*

Q2 Aggression feels like... *(Ex. hurt our body or your feelings, scary, etc.)*

Q3 Aggression sounds like... *(Ex. loud voice, mean, hurtful, etc.)*

Q4 Aggression can lead to... *(Ex. time-out, no friends, parents called, go to the office, etc.)*

5. Next, instruct the groups to collaborate and take turns recording responses for each of the quadrants. Groups should try to list at least 2 ideas for each heading.
6. Call out Q1 and ask each group to share one idea from their list. *(optional: assign the group member with the red card first then rotate to the next color for the next question)* Continue with the following quadrants. Elaborate with additional responses if necessary, pointing out violations of school rules (see school handbook) and legal consequences.

Laws:

ARS 13-2911: **“Interference or disruption”** to an educational institution.

ARS 13-1203: An **assault** is committed any time a person knowingly causes physical injury to another person. It is also any time that someone may feel physically threatened or when someone touches someone else to provoke or insult them.

ARS 13-1202: **Threatening or intimidating**; A person commits threatening or intimidating if the person threatens or intimidates by word or conduct; To cause physical injury to another person or serious damage to the property of another;

Activity 3: Problem Solve

1. Now, instruct each student to find a blank space on their group’s poster paper and illustrate their own emotion face showing how someone may feel if they see others displaying or expressing aggressive behaviors. Students may also write a feeling word near their emotion face. Display or brainstorm with class possible feeling words. *(Ex. scared, uncertain, confused, etc.)*
2. Circulate around to each group, commenting on the illustrations and asking the student to explain their face.
3. Next, instruct the groups to discuss ways they can calm themselves and keep their cool when their anger is rising. Circulate among the groups, listening for their responses and sharing ideas. *(Ex. count to 10, take deep breaths, rip scrap paper, write, listen to music, talk to someone, draw, dance, squish clay, blow bubbles, stretch, sports, exercise, hug yourself, etc.)*
4. Rotate to each group, several times, asking for one idea each time from group volunteers. Record each different idea on the board and lead the class in practicing the idea. If the student who provided the response feels comfortable allow him/her to lead the class.

Debrief:

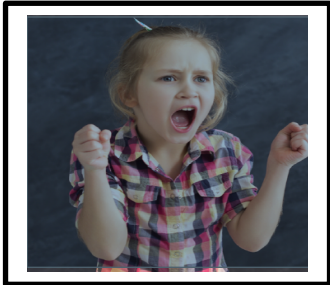
1. Write or display the following statements on the board and instruct each group to collaborate to complete the statement and be ready to report out.
2. Rotate to each group and ask a volunteer to read the statement with their group’s response.

“One way to keep school cool is to...”

Resources: www.kidshealth.org

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“Uncool” Matching Handout



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This behavior can have violent actions and is meant to harm others and make them feel unsafe.



Verbal Aggression

This emotion can make you feel hot or look red in the face. You may breathe faster or feel a stomach ache. You may feel like clenching your fists or yelling.